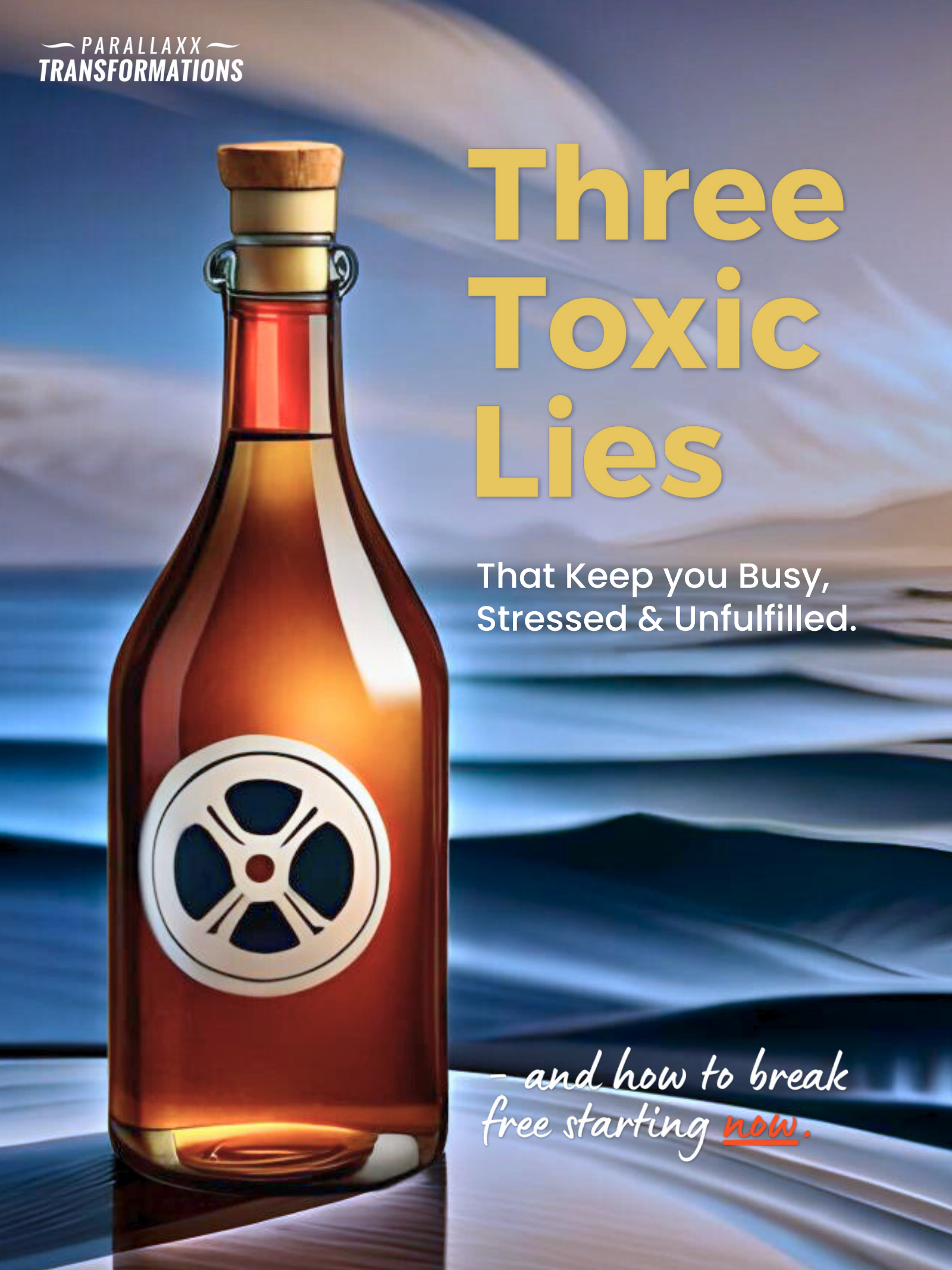
PARALLAXX
TRANSFORMATIONS



Three Toxic Lies

That Keep you Busy, Stressed & Unfulfilled.

– and how to break free starting now.



What if the busyness was never about *time*?

Hi, I'm Daniel Lawson.

I coach people who handle it all on their own. For over six years I've been running events, groups and coaching across nine countries, and I'm a credentialled coach and facilitator through the International Coach Guild.

Parallaxx comes from the idea that the same thing looks completely different depending on where you stand. Move a few steps and what looked fixed starts to shift. That's been true in my own life many times over, and it's what I see happen with the people I coach.

So I put this guide together for the capable version of you, the one everybody leans on, who's flat out and somehow still last on your own list.

Read it through, and stay with it to the end.

The last part is where it turns into something you can try on to make a difference this week.

Let’s face it. If you’re like many of the people I work with, you’re handling everything, and you’re last on the list.

You might recognise some of this:

- **Fine, or busy.** Someone asks how you're doing and that's the answer. Same answer for years.
- **Yes, when you'd rather say no.** Another project, another favour, another thing you'll just take care of.
- **The dinner you cancelled.** Something came in at the last minute, so friends or family got moved again.
- **Everybody's go-to.** People bring you their stuff. When they ask about yours, you say you're good.
- **Handling it so nobody's burdened.** You keep it to yourself and sort it on your own, because that seems kinder, or more efficient.
- **The target that keeps moving.** You hit it, 99% wasn't enough, so next time you go for 102.
- **What you want.** Someone asks what you'd like, for you, and you tell them you're easy.

If some of this sounds like your week, you're in good company. I ran most of it myself for about thirty years. And you get to keep everything you've built while you change it.

How Do I Do It All? (I DON'T)



When I was dating, and still now when I meet new people, I'll sometimes hear later that they thought I was fake at first. Nobody could be that happy, right?

And for a long time, they had a point. Somebody asked me once how I was doing. I said good. He asked how I really felt. I said not too bad. Being the nice, happy, easygoing one was how I kept everyone comfortable, me included.

These days, anyone who knows me will tell you the happy is real.

I left hustle culture years ago. I signed up for me and my own life instead.

Over time I built a way of living that lets me enjoy what I do, get things done and still have time and attention for the people I care about. That's what I'm sharing in this guide.

And I wasn't always like this. For years I was pretty much the opposite. Always feeling like time was running out, taking my frustration out on the people closest to me, and taking the same advice everyone else was accepting too about pushing harder.

It nearly crushed me. More on that later.

So this is where I want to show you how I got out of that, and how you can too.

What I want for you by the end of this guide is pretty simple. That you know something you want, for you, and that you've asked for it.

Because there's so much more life on the other side of how you're living right now. Time with the people you love, enjoying what you've worked so hard for, a day that is meaningful to you. It's all still there within you.

It just stays out of reach while busy keeps winning. And busy wins a lot, because it always comes with a really good reason.

So let's open that up...

What Keeps You Stuck?

There are **two big reasons** I hear for staying in it.

Reason #1 TIME

No surprises, the first one is time itself.

"I'll sort it when things calm down." When this project's done, after the busy season, once the kids are a bit older. I said versions of this for years. *"I need all the infrastructure around it before I can get started."* That one was mine.

And I get it, I do. But things don't calm down on their own, and living like this has a cost you won't find on any calendar.

We all have a limit, and later in this guide I'll share one of mine with you. If we keep putting ourselves last, at some point something else makes the decision for us. Our health, our relationships, the things we care about.

The good news is you don't have to wait for that. Small changes make a real difference, and they don't take a lot of extra time. They take being willing to try something new, and taking responsibility for what you want.



Reason #2 MONEY

The second reason is money. The idea that once there's more of it, everything else will sort itself out. I hear people say, *"When I earn more, I'll work less, take more holidays and pay someone to do the stuff I don't like doing."*

Waiting to earn more before you start living your life puts you last again. And it trains you to keep doing exactly what's keeping you stuck.

Reconnect starts with what's going on in you, because that's what changes how the rest of it feels. It's for people who want to take responsibility for the change in their own life.

And I know people make assumptions about me. *"Oh Daniel, you're doing well. You travel, you choose your own hours, you've got a great income. You don't have much to worry about."*



Yes, I've built this life. And that assumption is a long way off. Logistically, a lot of the time my life is more demanding than anything I had back in the nine to five. To build it I had to learn how to live it, and that meant a much healthier relationship with time and with my own emotions.

I've watched plenty of people earn far more than me and still crash, because they kept fixing what was out there instead of looking at how they were going about it.

Money, wanting more of it or not having enough, doesn't have to keep you stuck. When you learn to reconnect, you get more time for what matters, and you get to enjoy the money you make, because you're there for it.

What is Reconnect?

Reconnect is my 14-week one-to-one coaching programme. It's built on something I've seen in myself and in many of the people I coach: we stop asking for what we want, and then we forget we ever wanted it. Reconnect is where you find it again and start asking for it, with yourself, with the people closest to you, and in the life you're building. There's always time for what's most important once you know what it is.

What You'll Learn in This Guide

By the end of this guide you'll:

1. **See what busy is covering for**, and why being flat out can feel safer than saying what you want.
2. **See why more money hasn't settled it**, and why waiting until you've earned enough keeps putting your wants last.
3. **Start asking for what you want**, small and specific, this week, while keeping everything you've built.

Why I Created This Guide for You.

It was mid 2022. I'd been riding out the pandemic in Bali for over 18 months, and on paper life should have been great. Deep down I knew something had been missing for a while. Too long, really.

I was in a bit of a numb daze after a breakup, the first time I'd really experienced love. And much like love, I had no idea how to handle losing it. I was doing the best I could.

Sitting in a garden cafe, I get a call from my mum. As soon as she says she has some "not so great news", I already know what's coming. My Nana had passed away that morning.

We adored each other. I miss her a lot, and she was old, and it was her time. What broke my heart was that her wish for the last few years had been to see her grandson again. I'd been so busy I hadn't been home for seven years.

I had finally committed to a trip back to New Zealand for Christmas and New Year. With every hope that she'd hang on, she didn't make it. I still feel it.

I kept going anyway, the over-functioner that I am. Looking after business, pretending I was fine, building, serving, and taking on other people's growth as if it was my responsibility.

As if that wasn't enough, my body joined in. One morning I reached over to open the curtain, my lower back locked, and I dropped to the floor.

I couldn't stand up straight. I was coming up to 34, I knew this wasn't right, and at the same time my mind was telling me I'd never walk properly again. Four days in bed that felt like a lifetime.

What was wrong with me?

I stayed shut away on my own, hoping that somehow, someday, something would change. That I'd wake up and suddenly be able to enjoy the paradise around me the way it looks on social media.

The life I was longing for.



Looking back, I can see I was still wishing and hoping and relying on luck, and still doing nothing about it. I had to hit rock bottom to finally hear it.

Whatever your opinions and experiences of COVID, for me, a fit guy who barely ever gets sick, it was nothing like anything I'd been through. And not in a good way.

On top of the flu symptoms I lost muscle function. I couldn't walk, and I couldn't hold my phone up. On my own, thinking nobody could understand, I spiralled into a much darker place. I wanted to quit my business. It went as far as wondering **how I could quit on life.**

That was my breaking point. I couldn't take any more. I gave up and surrendered. I'd reached a point where nothing mattered anymore.

Those years were rough for a lot of us.

Maybe it made you, or forced you like it did me, to question everything. In my darkest hour, right at the bottom of the pit I'd found myself in, a small voice inside helped me look again. I started asking myself the big questions:

Who am I? And am I proud of this version of me?

What's really important in life?

Who really matters to me, and where do I want my time to go?

Whose idea of "success" am I trying to live up to anyway?

What do I want, that I stopped asking for?

What if life didn't have to feel so... empty?

And I think you already know this...

Time is the resource none of us get back. Money you can make more of. The years I didn't go home, I can't get back.

I've always been a bit obsessed with time and maybe a little addicted to feeling productive. Always looking at how to use what I've got in the most efficient way, and trying to live by principles that let me focus on what matters and set aside what doesn't.

This part took me way longer to see than I would have liked. I was so busy being efficient that I'd stopped asking myself what I wanted, and stopped asking anyone else for it too. Busy was the reason I gave.

Getting this right is a practice, something you keep coming back to, because what matters to you changes as you move through the different stages of life.

Thankfully, I recovered from COVID. It changed my brain, and yes, I let go of my business and a lot of my life as I knew it. It took me weeks, maybe months, to figure out who this new version of me was and how to live in this new reality.

Going through all of that, the despair, the hopelessness, feeling like a failure, brings a lot into focus. I can see now that a lot of the pain was only necessary because I didn't listen sooner. Ignoring it was never going to get me where I wanted to go.

I've always wanted to make a difference, so I knew I had to do something with what I'd learned. If I can help even a few people avoid their version of rock bottom, by sharing what can be done before they get there, that's progress. And progress is success for me.

So when I sat down to write this I said to myself, "I'm going to share everything I've learned, so people like you can start asking for what you want and change your life before something else makes that decision for you."

That's my "why" for this guide. **You are my "why".** You're capable and creative, and you mean a lot to the people closest to you and to your wider community. And the lies in this guide will keep you from the joyful, healthy, full life you want for yourself.

What Is Your Why?

Take a moment with this. *What is your "why"?* Why does it matter to you to take your life back into your own hands, now?

It's a question worth a real answer. Your "why" is what keeps you going when busy starts winning again.

It could be something like:

- *More evenings with the people you love, that you don't cancel.*
- *Friendships that run on their schedule as well as yours.*
- *Being a parent your kids get to see enjoying their life.*
- *Picking up something you loved before life got full.*
- *Looking after your body and your health while you still feel good.*
- *A day that is meaningful to you, with nothing work related in it.*

And whatever it is, it counts. If your "why" is an hour of Netflix without feeling guilty about it, I'll help you get there.

Reflect

What's my "why" for taking my life back into my own hands, starting now?

Write it below.
Ex: *More time with my partner, feeling calm instead of rushed, time for creativity, looking after myself without guilt, my physical and emotional health.*

Before we go further, I want you to know something. If you're stretched thin, pulled between priorities and working hard without ever feeling like you've done enough, you learned this, and it worked.

Many of us figured out young that being useful, being capable and being no trouble to anyone was the safest way to be included. It worked, so we never replaced it. But we were never shown what we couldn't see, so more effort hasn't changed it.

And many workplaces are looking for this when they hire. A senior HR manager at a big consulting firm told me her industry has a name for the person it likes to hire: the insecure overachiever. Those people keep running, and they're the most profitable. Told at year end that it wasn't enough, the answer is to give 120% next year.

So if you've felt like you're failing to keep up, please hear this. You've been very good at meeting a standard that moves every time you reach it.

And because you learned it, you can change it. That's what the rest of this guide is for.

Now, let's get into Toxic Lie #1...

Toxic Lie #1

"If I'm Not Busy, I'm Wasting Time."

If this sounds like you, you're in very good company. I've lived by this one for years, and I see it in many of the people I coach.

It runs deep in how a lot of us were raised and in everything we scroll past. And it's convincing, because busy looks responsible. Busy gets things done.

> **I just feel like I'm wasting my time. I could be more productive.**
>
> Me, on what goes on in my head

That's me, describing what goes on in my head when there's something I want and I haven't asked for it. It sounds like a time problem. Underneath it, I'm choosing the thing nobody can turn down.

Or this one...

> **I want it, but I can't be bothered. I feel tired. It's not that big of a deal.**
>
> Me, on what goes on in my head

Also mine. Tired is a great reason, nobody argues with tired. And "it's not that big of a deal" means I never have to find out what would happen if I said it was.

Chasing what you care about is great. But if you're so stretched that the only things you go after are the ones on somebody else's list, at some point it's worth asking whose life you're living.

How about this...

> **I need all the infrastructure around it before I can get started.**
>
> Me, on what goes on in my head

Mine again, and the sneakiest of the three, because it looks like growth. More planning, more systems, more getting ready. It's all real effort, and it can keep you going for years without ever asking anyone for anything.

And a strong work ethic is great. I value it, and I'd guess you do too. There's a big difference between working hard and using work so you never have to say what you want, and from the inside they can feel exactly the same.

Many of us continue to do this until we know better.

When I work with people on this, the same kinds of things come up. A few of them, in their words:

- ***"I disappointed myself a little bit when I cancelled on friends or my family. That I really regret sometimes."*** (a consultant, on track to becoming partner)
- ***"I'm the therapist now... everybody is just dumping on me."*** (a client of mine)
- ***"Once you've been there once and you worked so much, you're easily dragged into it again."*** (project manager)

Sound familiar? I remember those feelings really well myself.

Activity and accomplishment are two different things, and from the inside they're very easy to mix up.

Many of us value hard work, and I'm one of them. We also want a full life, with people in it and time to enjoy it.

So let's drop this lie and try something better. Are you with me?

TRUTH:

Busy is the most respectable reason there is to stop asking for what you want.

So what is the busy doing for you?

When you're flat out, you always have an answer when somebody asks how you are. You always have a reason to put off the things you want, because something more pressing has just come in. And it keeps you useful, which feels a lot safer than wanting something.

Ask for a night out together this week, and the other person gets to say no. Empty the dishwasher instead, and there's nothing for anyone to say no to.

So busy becomes the way you stay included without ever having to ask. It works, which is why it's so hard to put down.

And it's not only at work, right? What's the bet you run this at home, with friends and with family too?

And there's something I've seen over and over in the people I work with...

TRUTH:

Slowing down only helps once you know what you're slowing down for.

Many of us think the answer is to rest more. And rest is great. But for a lot of capable people, empty time is uncomfortable, because there is nothing to hide behind.

A consultant I interviewed got put on a slow project after years of running flat out. She joked that she was hoping not to get a burnout but a "bore-out", because she was so bored. And that slow patch is where it changed for her:

"Then I had the time to really think about my life and what I'm doing and how much I'm actually working and not seeing friends that much, and family that much."

What changed things for her was the same job, done in less time and taken a bit less seriously.

So slowing down by itself doesn't do much. Slowing down, and knowing what you want to do with that time, changes a lot.

Action Step #1
Notice What Busy Is Covering

Ready to do something about it?

The first step is simple. Start noticing the language. The way you talk about how busy you are is doing a job, and once you can see the job, you get to choose.

For example:

- ***"Flat out, but good."*** An answer that closes the conversation, so nobody has to go any further, including you.
- ***"I'll do it when things calm down."*** Moves what you want to a date that never shows up in the calendar.
- ***"It's not that big of a deal."*** You never have to find out what would happen if you said it was.
- ***"I'll just do it myself, it's quicker."*** Keeps you capable, and keeps everyone else from contributing.

This is common sense. What you say about your time shapes how you spend it. Until you see what busy is doing for you, no productivity app or scheduling trick is going to give you what you're after.

Your life doesn't have to be run by your calendar. You get to choose what goes in it, once you know what you want there.

So by now the capable part of you is probably saying, "Got it Daniel, makes sense. Where do I start?"

FIRST, NOTICE WHAT YOU SAY WHEN SOMEONE ASKS HOW YOU ARE.

“Is it that I don't have the time, or that I haven't decided what I want to use it for?”

Reflect

What do you say when someone asks how you are, or what you'd like?

List them below: *Flat out… Busy but good… Can't complain… All good… It's been a big week… Next month will be quieter… I'm easy, whatever you like… Don't worry about me… It's fine, I'll sort it…*

When you start noticing how you answer, to yourself and to other people, you'll see how often busy does the talking for you. Sometimes I notice myself saying "all good" before the other person has even finished asking.

And every time it does the talking, you skip a chance to admit a personal truth. Do it for long enough and it starts to feel like who you are.

So what changes this?

Count how often "fine" and "busy" come out of you

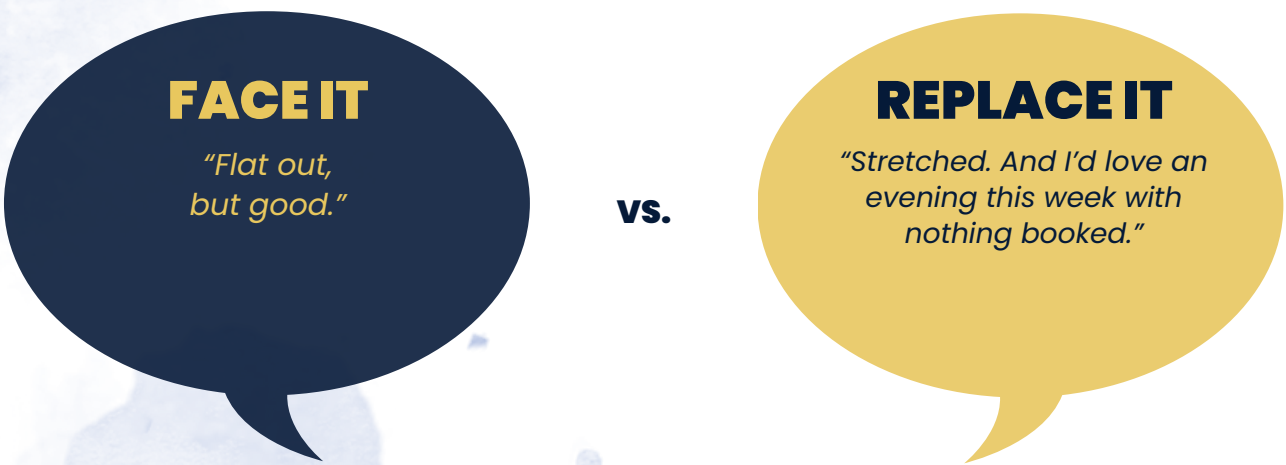
Just for today, notice it. Write the phrases you use in the left column, and put a tick in the right column every time you catch yourself saying one, in your head or to someone else. Counting is enough to start shifting it.

MY "FINE, BUSY" ANSWERS	DAILY TOTAL

TOTAL TIMES TODAY: _____

Face It, Then Replace It

Once you can see it, you can change it. Next time one of your usual answers comes out, stop for a second and face it. Then swap it for what's true for you in that moment, and add something you want.



BONUS: Write a few of your own swaps here, so they're ready when the old answer comes out.

FACE IT: MY USUAL ANSWER	**REPLACE IT:** WHAT'S TRUE, AND WHAT I WANT

That's a small way to start loosening busy's grip. The bigger change comes when you start letting people see what you want, a little at a time. It sounds like a lot, and it's very doable.

And it starts with noticing what you say, to yourself and to everyone else.

Let's move on to Lie #2...

Toxic Lie #2

"When I've earned enough, I'll finally live the way I want to."

One of the most convincing lies we tell ourselves is that more hours mean more money, and more money means we'll finally get to relax. Another version goes, *"Once I've got everything handled, then I'll have time for me."*

The "then" never comes. There's always another thing to handle, and you're very good at handling things.

Do you know anyone like this, or at least anyone who acts like it? Thinking about work from the moment they wake up until their head hits the pillow?

When you believe this, the days fill up with meetings and commitments that don't really matter to you, while you wait for the breakthrough that'll change everything. And in the meantime you're running in place, because nothing changes unless you change.

These are some of the things I hear:

- The question a senior HR manager in consulting hears from the consultants she works with: *how can I say no, when I'm paid a lot of money to deliver really high quality work?*
- ***"I didn't want to burden other people with any issues that I had. I'd manage those myself, and I kept those internally. What I didn't realise is that potentially that was what was causing the problems."*** (a client of mine)
- ***"First of all not able to say no. And people mistreat me often because I don't correct it."*** (another client)
- ***"They were kind of supportive... because I didn't see them so much, and it was always after my time schedule."*** (a consultant, on track to becoming partner)

Does any of this sound familiar? There's a better, healthier way to live and work, and you don't have to keep over-functioning to get there.

What you're looking for starts on the inside, and more effort on the outside was never going to get you to it. There's a quicker and much kinder way to what you want. So this is the truth:

TRUTH:

More money doesn’t hand you what you stopped asking for.

Money tends to make more of whatever's already there. If what's going on inside you hasn't been sorted, it makes those challenges bigger and harder to get through.

Sure, money can buy you the freedom to go anywhere and do anything. If you're still running the same patterns inside, you take them with you.

Feeling free starts on the inside.

Let me tell you how trying to do more and earn more, so I'd feel better, nearly crushed me...

I was wrapping up my twenties and I'd hit my career goal, international business development manager for a tech company. It came with all the perks and a good six-figure income, and with the pressure of higher sales targets every quarter.

I hit my target, and it cost me my soul. Then the next year it went up by another 10%, so I had to do all of it again, plus more.

A few weeks into the new job, and still really proud of being a successful, suit-wearing member of society.



As an ambitious high-achiever I kept looking for ways to earn more, so I wouldn't have to push so hard and feel stretched all the time. I wanted to relax and be with my family and the people I care about. Less work, more life.

The thing was, whatever I did, it never felt like enough. I couldn't relax or be there for whoever I was with, I was always thinking about what was next at work, let alone enjoying my personal life.

And the pressure to keep doing more ramped up the stress and the worry about the future. I got to a point of mental and emotional exhaustion, and it spilled onto the people closest to me, which kept me even further from what mattered most.

And then I lost my sense of identity. I felt cut off from myself and from everyone around me.

Even after I resigned from corporate, made five times my old salary in a new role and had full control of my own schedule, everything I thought would fix it made it worse.

So I finally had to face what I'd been avoiding. I had to admit I didn't have it all figured out. That I couldn't do this on my own. That I needed to let someone in.

Then something shifted in me. I took responsibility for my life, and I owned what I'd been going through.

It made me look within and ask what's most important to me, and who I am. What I found was how I want to feel, day to day, and that had very little to do with the markers of success I'd been chasing.

Life is an experience, and I didn't need more money to start creating a healthier, fuller one from today.

It became really clear how to feel present, relaxed and content, because I could see I had a choice in how I was creating my inner state. And if I didn't like how it felt, I could change it.

I also learned I couldn't always choose my mindset and emotions perfectly straight away. What I could do was acknowledge myself for the small steps, and keep showing up.

So I invested in my own coaching to speed it up. I wanted to work with someone who was getting the results I wanted and could show me the way, as quickly as possible.

It was incredible. Things moved fast, and people around me were noticing the shift.

Someone even called me a "serial winner"!

I started imagining what this could change in every part of my life.

And that's when I realised that the way to a richer life was giving myself permission to work less, and to enjoy more of what I wanted to do.

My plan was to work less, and spend that time on things I thought I might enjoy. I got curious about interests I'd never made time for, picked the few I was most excited about and committed to giving them a go. I said yes to me. I made myself a priority and booked myself into my calendar first.

But there was still a problem...

By this stage I was coaching emerging entrepreneurs to build lifestyle businesses, and I'd moved to Bali. Waterfalls, CrossFit, free-diving, motorbike rides around the volcanoes.

I'd often hear, ***"Wow Dan, you're living the dream."***

And it still felt empty. I was lonely. Nobody was inviting me anywhere, and it took me a while to see why. I wasn't initiating the things that were deeper and more uncomfortable myself. I'd stopped asking.

I was ashamed to admit it. Was I weak?







I realised I'd taken the same overachieving that built me an impressive corporate job and used it to build an impressive-looking lifestyle. External marker of success, tick.

Beyond frustrated, I was numb. So I went back to what I knew, went deeper into my own development, and took more responsibility for how I wanted to feel. And being a recovering over-functioning coach, I documented and systemised what I was learning as I went.

I called it
“Mission Reconnect: reconnect with self, reconnect with others, reconnect with life.”

If I could make it possible to go from the edge of mental, physical and emotional burnout to creating a life to fall in love with, I'd be super proud.

After another two years of deeper development and coaching, and almost a year after that of testing, tweaking and refining, I created ***"Reconnect: a life to fall in love with."***

Then I found I could get these results for other people too, anyone who really wants to change their life. So I started taking other busy, capable people through **Reconnect**.

We've had wonderful results with incredible people, many of them overworked and ambitious, right where I used to be, using the roadmap I wish I'd had.

It's taken them from never enough hours in the day, to having the time, attention and fulfilment for what matters most to them.

And through building **Reconnect**, I found a happy, healthy relationship with my partner after eight-plus years of being single. I've also stopped worrying about problems that don't exist yet, because I can be here, now, and enjoy it.



Reconnect has helped many capable people get their focus, presence and a life that feels like theirs back, like Katherine...

*I was scattered and unfocused. My business, relationships, and emotions all felt overwhelming. My mindset was holding me back, but **I couldn't shift my thinking on my own.** Daniel supported and challenged me across all these areas. Now **I feel more centred and present.** Everything has shifted.*

Katherine J, Australia

And Gena...

*I was stuck in self-sabotaging patterns I couldn't understand. Procrastination and emotional overload were draining my energy. **I was trying to figure it out by myself,** but I couldn't see where the actual problem was coming from. **The sessions were a game-changer.***

Gena K, Bulgaria





Or Allan...

*I was trying to achieve something but **couldn't get there on my own.** I didn't always believe the future I wanted was possible. Daniel has a way about him that makes you feel comfortable to be who you are. He asks the right questions for you to see where you need to step up. Now I believe it's possible. **A good coach gets you there faster,** and Daniel accelerates the process.*

Allan C
United Kingdom

I'm certain you can get results like these too, if you're willing to take responsibility and approach your life a bit differently.

For now, let's turn this story into something you can try on this week.

Action Step #2
Catch What You've Stopped Asking For

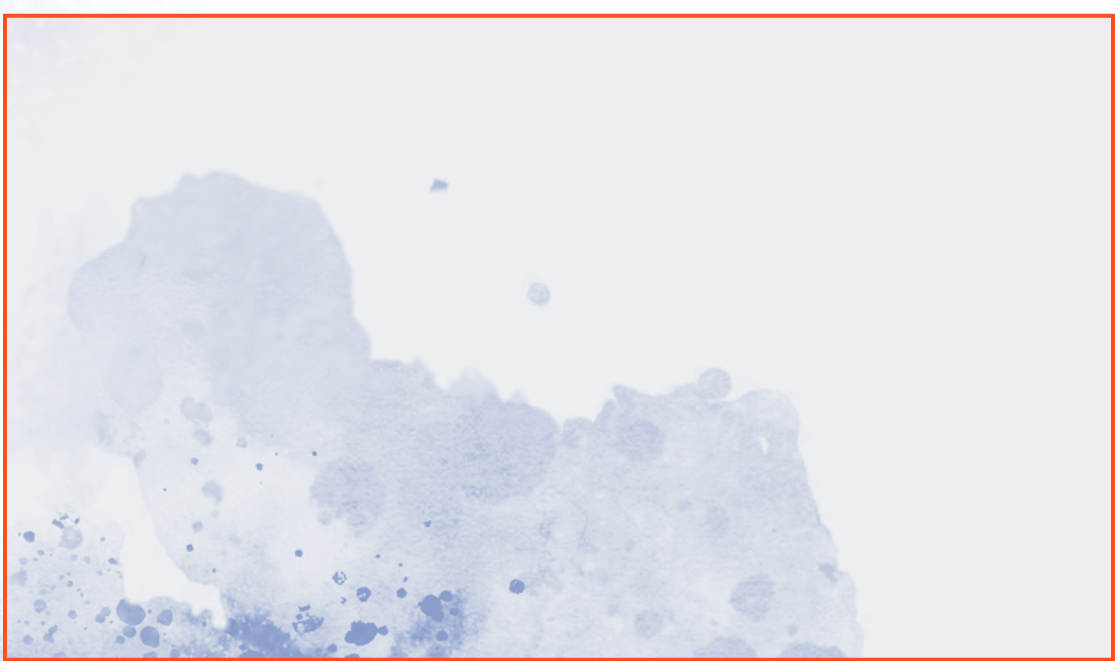
By now you can probably see how busy and handling it all have been shaping how you feel, as well as how you spend your time.

To get more of the life you want, you have to see where your time is going, and then be brave and honest enough to let some of it go.

Get clear on where your yes goes

Where do you say yes when you'd rather say no?

Ex: *Taking on the extra project, being the one who stays late, needing the last word when it doesn't matter, saying yes to plans you'd prefer to skip, picking up what other people leave behind.*



What do you handle yourself, as to not rely upon or bother others?

Could be things like... *Sorting it before anyone notices, keeping a hard week to yourself, not mentioning what you need because everyone's busy, being "low maintenance", going without sleep, exercise or downtime so everything else gets done.*

What do you do instead of asking for what you want?

Could be things like... *More work, chores, tidying, scrolling, a drink at the end of the day, food, planning, perfecting something that's already done.*

Leave Something Not Done.

There's a task near you that somebody else could handle, and that you'd normally have finished by now. Leave it.

What is it, who could take it, and when are you leaving it?

Remember, this is not a test for them if they do it. This is about your right and your responsibility to get the most out of your life, in a way that lasts.

Long hours of busywork don't guarantee more money, less stress or more of the life you want.

And until you get clear on where your yes goes, you'll keep wondering why the feelings you'd love more of stay just out of reach.

You're doing great! Now let's move on to the third and final toxic lie that keeps you busy, stretched and feeling like it's never enough...

Toxic Lie #3

"One more target, and then I'll feel like I've done enough."

Essh, this is a big one. The belief that ticking off one more thing out there will finally make you feel successful. It catches a lot of us, especially the ambitious part of us who always wants more from life.

It's built on the idea that there's a finish line, and once you cross it you'll feel satisfied. So you stay switched on, always striving for the next thing, and you get busyness, stress and a feeling of never quite being enough.

So what happens? You set another goal and go at it again. Right?

The problem is it treats success like a destination, as if one day we'll arrive, stop striving and soak up how accomplished we feel.

At the risk of being a bit morbid, the only arrival any of us are guaranteed is the end of life. It's a little late to enjoy our wins then!

I learnt a long time ago that success, like life, is something I keep growing into. When I hit a goal I naturally set the next one. And what I got from it came from who I became going after it, much more than from hitting it.

A senior HR manager at a consulting firm described this to me as a toxic relationship. You're told at year end it wasn't enough, so next year you give 120%, trying harder to please someone who can't be pleased.

And it's often the most capable people who run this the longest, because they're the ones most likely to try to figure it out alone, doing variations of what they've always done and asking nobody for anything.

What a shame, right? Because they believe that if they set and hit enough goals, the feeling of being enough will eventually show up.

Please trust me on this. You could be getting a C- across the board of life and still feel really proud and accomplished. (I know that standard makes you cringe, but you get my point!)

How do I know? Because I know a lot of people who live like this, and I've coached many of them there faster than they thought possible.

What you share with the people who get there quickly, even with modest results, is that you're already willing to look at this and take responsibility for changing it.

People like you, with good self-awareness and a healthy relationship with their ego, tend to end up in my programmes. And this is how that same HR manager described the consultants who are stuck in it, in their words:

> *"I feel like a loser... I gave my all, but it wasn't enough."*
>
> And what they're missing:
> *"Learning how I can be that person who tells myself you do a good job... and this is a good job, now I go to bed."*

Everyone who shows up for themselves and acts on what's important to them gets to feel successful. I don't need to tell you how much you've already done. I doubt I'd need to stretch you very far for you to see your own results...

So I sense what you're after is being able to *feel* the success that's already there, every day, as part of how you live.

It's already there within you, and it can come through pretty quickly. First we need to know what you want.

When you step back and get really clear on something you want for yourself...

Something you're emotionally driven by, as well as logically connected to...

And you can see that going after it matches who you're becoming...

You can start acknowledging yourself along the way...

And that feeds a real sense of satisfaction and worth, from being you.

This is a truth I live by, and it sits at the core of **Reconnect**.

TRUTH:

When you know what's important, you can ignore what's not.

Now let's turn this into something you can try on...

Action Step #3
Decide What You Want

DECIDE WHAT YOU WANT

What have you wanted for a while now, and told yourself could wait?

What have you got very good at not needing?

Hint: it's often what you'd make sure the people you love never went without.

What would having it today give you, if you gave it your attention?

Be honest with yourself here. Think about what you've been going without, and let yourself picture the opposite.

What do you need to communicate, what would you say and when?

Keep it small and specific. A time in the calendar, and the words you'd use.

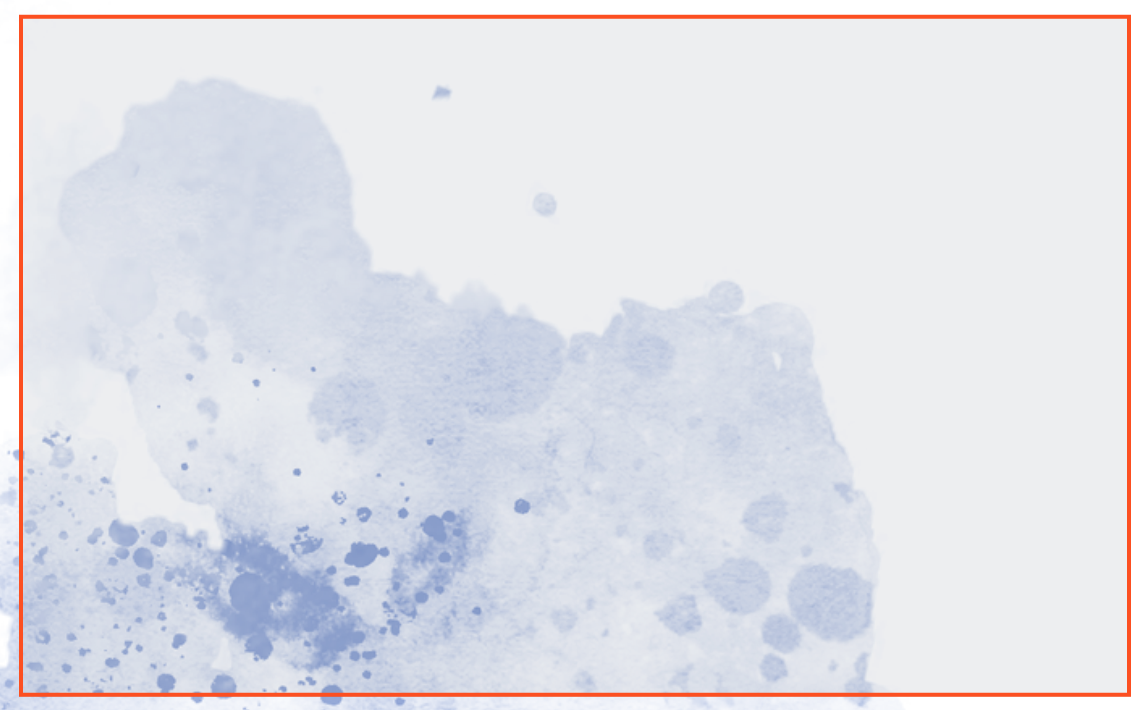
Now, Imagine Saying It.

Seriously. Close your eyes and picture yourself saying it. Who's there, what you say and how it feels to have said it. Then picture the week after. Whatever their response was, someone knows what you want now, and you're still standing.

Take five minutes to write about it here.

Write it as if it's already happened. You said it. How did it go, and how do you feel?

Many of the people I work with find the response matters less than they expected. A client told me after her first clear no, *"It didn't hurt that much. It got me nervous, but that was basically it."*



Fantastic Work!

The point is that you can have what you want, whether that's being a more present parent, a more loving partner, feeling different day to day or growing into a version of you you're proud of. It just won't happen while you're spreading yourself thin and trying to do everything at once. That road leads to running yourself down and falling short, everywhere.

If you're not clear on what you want for yourself, you won't get it efficiently, or at all.

“Clarity is power when it comes to how you spend your time.”

Once you're clear, you need a way of living that doesn't rely on hope, luck or willpower. Something that keeps what you want at the front and makes it easier to say no to what you don't. Done every day, it lets the noise fade into the background without costing you your priorities.

If you're not clear on what you want yet, or you don't have a way to put it first, I can help you find a simpler, more enjoyable way there.

And if you're stretched, overwhelmed and still not feeling like you've done enough, you already know this...

The hard truth is this: if you don't get clear on what you want, you won't get it efficiently, or at all.

TRUTH:

You're either going to change by design, or by disaster.

If you're familiar with my style, you know I like to keep it real.

If nothing changes, at some point something else makes the decision for you. Maybe you're already seeing the cracks... and you know what I mean.

You still have time to make a change and turn things around.

Maybe someone close to you has told you something's missing in you, and you couldn't argue.

Maybe you've hit every target and you still feel behind.

Maybe a quiet week came along and you didn't know what to do with it.

Maybe you cancelled on someone you love again this month.

If the cracks are showing, take them as your check engine light. Please hear me when I say **there's still time.**

What we've covered together is the tip of the iceberg. Now it's on you to take action. Let's quickly sum up your three-step plan:

Action Step #1: Notice What Busy Is Covering
Start by noticing what you say when someone asks how you are. Then swap the usual answer for what's true, and something you want.

Action Step #2: Catch What You've Stopped Asking For
See where your yes goes, what you handle so nobody else could, and what fills the gap instead of asking. Then leave something unfinished.

Action Step #3: Decide What You Want
This is where the real difference gets made. Decide something you want for yourself, keep it small and specific, and let the people it involves know. Whatever they say, it's no longer something you keep to yourself. The life you'll fall in love with starts there.

You can't just think about it. Life doesn't happen in your head. **You need to BE about it**, and feel it as you go.

And if you're thinking, *"Daniel, this makes sense. But what do I do next, so it sticks?"*

Great question. This is the work I do in **Reconnect**. It's my 14-week one-to-one programme, where we find what you stopped asking for and you start asking, making **YOU a priority**, changing how **YOU experience your life**, and building **a sense of success you can feel every day.**

Your Next Step



Before any of that, have a look around my website. Pick the path that fits you, for men or for women, and you'll find reflections, stories and conversations from our groups, The Reconnected Man and The Reconnected Woman, with more quality insights to keep you moving.

GO FURTHER

They all tried to do it on their own first.

Stories from Reconnect clients across Europe, the US and Australia, in their words. A few of them...

I was emotionally stunted. I couldn't connect with my emotions or express how I felt. ***I thought I was managing everything internally, but that was causing the problems.*** *Daniel challenged me to go deeper. Now* ***I've found contentment I didn't know was possible.*** *Simple things give me this warmer feeling. You can work it out yourself, but you'll miss so much.*

Brian B
United Kingdom

Scan or tap to watch Brian's story →





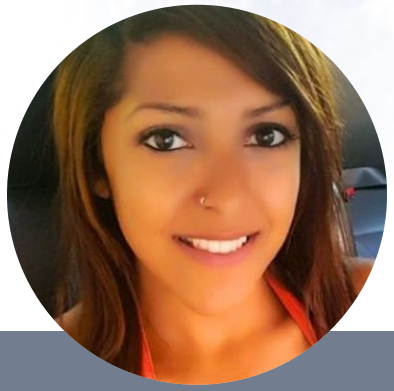
I wasn't planning adventures or fully doing what I love. I needed support and inspiration to integrate both into my life. ***I was missing that balance between building what matters and actually living the life I wanted.*** *… Now* ***I'm ensuring I plan adventures while building what matters.*** *I am truly blessed to have him in my proximity.*

Alicia Ann
Australia

I felt lost, ***suppressing my true feelings out of fear and shame.*** *I wasn't pursuing passions that enriched my life. I thought I had to settle. Daniel's approach to vulnerability offered me a lifeline. Now I cherish incredible friendships and pursue passions that enrich my life.* ***I don't have to settle.***

Dave M
United Kingdom





I was experiencing challenges but couldn't identify the real underlying issues. I was stuck on the surface, ***unable to break through to clarity on my own.*** *Daniel has an incredible way of asking questions that goes straight to the real issue... I saw a massive change within just days.* ***The breakthroughs came faster than I expected.***

Kathryn
Australia

I wasn't taking full responsibility for my own life. I didn't understand my values or have a clear vision. Daniel explains things in a way that ***leads you to find the answers yourself.*** *He does it with such ease and calmness that trusting him comes naturally. Now* ***I feel the shift in my mindset.*** *I'm on the way to becoming the best version of myself.*

Laura B
Latvia



Coaching for people who handle it all on their own.



Reconnect is where you find what you stopped asking for, and **FINALLY** start asking again.

CHECK IT OUT

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Reconnect with yourself.
Reconnect with others.
Create a life to fall in love with.

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